



# Dawn of diesel



**Bugatti railcar** France 1932

*Eight-wheel bogie  
(set of wheels that pivot)*

122 mph (196 km/h)

*High, sloping  
driver's windshield*



**GHE T1** Germany 1933

*Body design  
tapers at rear*

The first  
GWR completed  
**59,652 miles**  
(96,000 km) in  
its first year.



25 mph (40 km/h)



80 mph (129 km/h)

**GWR streamlined railcar** UK 1934

*Small, sliding  
windows*

*Headlight*



45 mph (72 km/h)

As engine technology developed in the early 20th century, some engineers turned away from steam in favor of locomotives that ran on diesel fuel. Diesel-engine trains entered service in numbers from 1930s onward.

Diesel engines required less maintenance than steam locomotives and could be operated without extra crew to stoke the boiler. This made some, such as the **VC Porter No.3** and **DR Class Kö**, ideal as low-speed switchers. Many early diesel trains used their engines to drive the wheels